

Powerful Mobile i5

Intel to launch fast mobile Core i5
540M processors clocked at 2.66GHz

Chrome store

Google launches a web store for free
and paid Chrome OS apps

Cellphone test



Sony Ericsson Xperia X10

as a 65K colour screen under Android 1.6, a single touch interface, a limited application storage space of 512MB, no Adobe Flash support in the browser, no DivX video playback, no FM radio, no video-calling, and no GPS navigation solution that does not entail data charges.

Verdict

At its incredible price, the phone has too many lacking features that will be missed by regular smartphone users. However, if you can live without them, there is no denying that the Xperia X10 has some truly great aspects, both in terms of hardware and software, from the capable camera to the snazzy Timescape UI. If you are simply looking for a good touchscreen phone, consider the much cheaper Nokia 5800 XpressMusic, or for a comparably priced touchscreen experience along with a full QWERTY keyboard, try out the N97 Mini.

Motorola

Milestone

The first thing we noticed as we got this baby in our hands was how solidly this beauty in black was built. Once out of the box, we were pleased by its large 3.7 inch capacitive touch-screen with four capacitive keys under it for back, menu, home and search. Unlike other sliders, where spring systems snap open the phone at a light push, Milestone requires you to push the upper part all the way till it settles with a reassuring click, with about one-thirds of the screen still overlapping the keyboard panel.

The device we received was updated with the latest Android 2.1 and it really fulfills most of our tech-appetite. A significant upgrade over v1.6, Android 2.1 now has support for multi-touch which complements the excellent touch capabilities of Milestone. It also has a better email experience, improved camera controls, a revamped on screen keyboard, smart dictionary (it actually includes your contact names, Neat!), Bluetooth 2.1 and HTML5 support. The operation is smooth and there is no lag whatsoever. The functions are largely intuitive with most actions possible either by long pressing the screen or tap-



Motorola Milestone

ping the menu button. The Android has really started to mature beautifully with most things now falling in place, and the right place, with the latest version. Multi-tasking is smooth and efficient and would be a benchmark for the upcoming Apple OS 4.0. Although there was no option to be seen to close the apps, this did not induce any lag.

The on screen keyboard is excellent, especially with the haptic feedback enabled. The hardware keyboard is ergonomically designed with the keys slightly protruded and better spaced. The D-Pad might seem like a gimmick, but we found it extremely useful when fingertips get too big for selecting small links or accurate cursor positions. But what takes the device home is the high-dpi capacitive touchscreen. Although the brightness and richness of the colors is slightly inferior to the iPhone screen, the sensitivity of the touch is second to none and at least at par with that of the iPhone. Also, the text is smoother and more readable on the Milestone due to its superior DPI.

The bundled apps are fairly usable with the Email app one of the neatest we have seen on a smartphone. It automatically detects the incoming and outgoing servers for the typed email address and configures everything without a hitch. Numerous accounts can be created. The accounts can be checked separately, or in a combined inbox which collects mails from all the accounts. Media player is excellent, where individual tracks or albums



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